Managing Teams and Groups

(Chapter 3 in textbook)

Trimester 2.2025

Are You part of Team ?

Are You part of Group ?

Group or Team?

Group or Team?

A company forms a committee of five employees from different departments to attend a weekly meeting about office sustainability. Each member shares updates from their own department but works independently and has no shared goals or tasks.

Team and Group Dynamics

- **Group dynamics**
  - patterns of interaction, relationships, and behaviors among team members

Team and Group Dynamics

A group of five students is tasked with creating a marketing pitch for a simulated product launch.

From the start, group interaction reveals distinct roles:

- Sophie naturally becomes the ***leader:*** organizes meetings, sets deadlines, and keeps everyone focused.
- Dan takes on the role of the ***idea generator:*** offers many creative suggestions.
- Mina acts as the ***mediator:*** steps in when Dan's ideas clash with Sophie's structured plans.
- Leo is the ***silent contributor:*** listens intently but rarely speaks unless directly asked.
- Julia becomes the ***critic*****:** questions suggestions and ensures they stay realistic and evidence-based.

Team and Group Dynamics

- **In-group bias:**
  - process by which members of a group favor or treat members of their own group with preferences over others
  - ***Us*** vs ***Them***
    - ✓ can be a way of uniting teams towards performance
    - x can lead to prejudice and distrust, hatred and anger towards out-groups

In-group Bias (Example)

At a multinational marketing firm, a project team is made up of employees from different regional offices: three are from the company's headquarters in New York, and two are from the recently opened office in Bangkok.

During team meetings, the New York team members often **agree with each other's suggestions** and **praise one another's ideas**, even when they are underdeveloped. However, when the Bangkok team members offer suggestions—often grounded in local market insights—the New York group is **quick to question them or dismiss** them as "not fitting the global strategy."

Team and Group Dynamics

- **Out-group bias:**
  - people within one's own group, or in another group, who are treated inequitably or more negatively because they are not seen as belonging to one's own in-group

Out-group Bias (Example)

At a tech company, a new employee named Fatima joins the development team. She is originally from Morocco and wears a hijab. Most of her teammates are from the local country and have worked together for years.

Despite Fatima's strong credentials and experience, some team members privately express doubts about her "fit" with the company culture. When she proposes a new way to streamline the testing process, her idea is politely acknowledged but not seriously considered. A week later, when a similar suggestion comes from a longtime team member, it's immediately discussed and implemented.

Types of Groups

Formal groups

Informal groups

(eg. social groups, interest groups)

Types of Groups

Closed groups

(skills, capabilities)

Open groups

(similar interests)

Type of group in this class?

- ❑ Formal group
- ❑ Closed group
- ❑ Open group
- ❑ Informal group

Social Facilitation

- The phenomenon of an increase in performance in the presence of others
- Occurs around simple tasks
- Training and experience can be critical aspects of successful teamwork

Example of Social Facilitation

A sales team is participating in a monthly performance challenge where the top performer wins a bonus and public recognition. During the final week, each team member is making client calls from the same open-plan office.

Jon, who is usually a solid but **average performer**, becomes noticeably **more energetic** and persuasive on his calls when he **sees his colleagues** nearby also working hard and trying to close deals. The competitive atmosphere and the presence of others push Jon to outperform his usual numbers. He books twice as many appointments as in a typical week.

Groupthink

- The tendency of members of a group to seek and maintain harmony in a group
- The team reinterprets information so that members can avoid any thinking that might disrupt the strong team culture
- Can cause groups of people to feel shared negative emotions and have shared negative experiences

Social Loafing

- A situation in which some members of a group exert less work effort than their peers
- **Reasons**
  - People less accountable for their behaviors when they know other people will pick up the slack
  - Lack of confidence
  - Being poorly matched to the job
  - Personal problems

Social Loafing

- **Ways to solve:**
  - Have clear roles and responsibilities
  - Accountability
  - Team and individual performances are measured

Developing Teams

- **Team stages**
  - **Stages of team development**
    1. **Forming**
       – people get to know one another
       – work out status, power and roles
    2. **Storming**
       – align with in-group members
       – conflict may start as attempts to deal with group outcomes and process
       – problems with group dynamics

Developing Teams

- **Team stages**
  - **Stages of team development**
    3. **Norming**
       – norms are established
       – members understand their roles and responsibilities
    4. **Performing**
       – team is ready to perform
    5. **Adjourning**
       – team has completed its tasks

Example of Group Development Stages

a.) Group members argue over what to do about one of the five team members who missed two early (and important) meetings and deadlines.

b.) The group completes the assignment and submits it to the professor for a grade. After final exams are over, the group gets together for pizza to celebrate the successful completion of the project.

c.) After being assigned a semester-long group project by their professor, newly formed groups meet to figure out how to get started on the project, who will do what task, etc.

d.) Group members and the group leader perform their tasks effectively and make a great deal of progress toward achieving their project goals and objectives.

e.) Students have agreed upon key goals and objectives and have developed a true sense of “teamwork”; the leader is accepted and members have assumed their individual roles.